Plan a circle: “The Monkey’s Paw”

W. W. Jacobs (1902) · public-domain short story · grades 7–10 · ~1 week / two meetings. Rights: Public domain.

Kit section 5 (group agreement & calendar) filled in for one text — a finished plan students see before writing their own. ***Tinted italic*** = sample answers.

Text, group, and target

Text / author / edition	***“The Monkey’s Paw” — W. W. Jacobs (1902). Public-domain short story.***
Group / period / dates	***Dev’s group · Period __ · Meetings ___ & ___***
Grade / TEKS target (p. 3)	Grade 7 · §110.23 — 7(A): theme through characters/events; 6(C,D): support inferences; 1(D): student-led discussion.
Learning intention	We are learning to explain how the family’s wishes and the story’s structure reveal a theme about fate and greed.
Success criteria	I bring one open question, cite two details with locations, respond to a peer, and name how my thinking changed.

Reading map & calendar

Chunk	Read through	Meeting date · leader
1	***The paw arrives, Morris’s warning, and the first wish.***	***Tue · Leader: Dev***
2	***The consequence (Herbert’s death) and the final two wishes.***	***Thu · Leader: Nora***

Members & first-meeting jobs (p. 7 roles)

Member	First job	Rotates to (next meeting)
Dev	***Questioner***	***Summarizer***
Nora	***Summarizer***	***Clarifier***
Theo	***Clarifier***	***Evidence tracker***
Ivy	***Predictor***	***Questioner***

Text-specific discussion questions (open — more than one answer)

- **Predict:** After Mr. White wishes for money, what will “fate rules people’s lives” cost him? What clue hints at it?
- **Question:** Why might Jacobs keep the third wish’s result offstage?
- **Clarify:** What does Morris mean that the paw grants wishes but with a price?
- **Summarize:** Order the three wishes and their results, without opinion.
- **Interpret the theme:** How do the wishes reveal a theme about tempting fate or greed? Use two details.

> **Optional Jigsaw lenses (p. 4):** ***Character*** (Mr. and Mrs. White) · ***Plot*** (the three-wish structure and foreshadowing) · ***Mood*** (the storm and the quiet house) · ***Theme*** (fate vs. desire) · ***Language*** (warnings and the knock).

Sample 3–2–1 notes: Theo, plot lens

Name: Theo · Home group: Dev's group · Period __ · Meetings ___ & ___ · Section: "The Monkey's Paw," Chunk 2 · Expert lens: Plot

> **What a finished prep looks like.** Kit section 6 / Organizer A completed for one reader, so students can compare their notes to a strong model.

Questions ***Was the third wish the right choice?*** ***Could any wish have ended well?***	**3 · Important ideas** ***1. The paw grants three wishes, but each carries a cost.*** ***2. The wished-for money arrives as compensation for Herbert's death.*** ***3. The parents wish him back, then wish him gone again.***
Vocabulary ***fakir = a holy man.*** ***talisman = an object believed to hold power.***	**2 · Supporting details** ***1. Morris throws the paw on the fire (early). → Warns that the wishes are dangerous.*** ***2. The knocking stops after the third wish (ending). → Shows the cost of undoing fate.***

1 · Summary in my own words

A family gains a cursed wishing paw; their wishes bring money through their son's death, and they undo the horror with the last wish.

Bring to the circle

My interpretation: ***Meddling with fate for gain brings ruin, not reward.***
Synthesis (two lenses): ***The three-wish structure (plot) enacts the theme: each wish shows that forcing fate exacts a price. Text points: the first wish (Chunk 1) and the last (Chunk 2).***
After discussion: ***My thinking became clearer once the group compared evidence.***

TEKS evidence: 6(C,D) supported inference; 7(A) theme through characters/events; 1(D) response to a peer. · Pair with the PlotPoint "The Monkey's Paw" room.